

## **8. Presentation skills**

# Academic Presentations Form

## 1. Introduction

What do you intend to do?  
How do you intend to do it?



## 2. Main Body

State your points: information and argument.



## 3. Conclusion

Summarise.  
Invite questions.

# Opening the presentation

- Greet the audience.
- State your name and the title of your presentation.
- Give a brief outline of your talk: what are you going to talk about? Put keyword onto one PowerPoint slide.
- Smile and look at your audience, are they listening to you?!

# Main body of presentation

- Use a different slide for each main point.
- Provide a useful title for each slide (keyword that summarises main idea).
- Include any statistics and dates you mention.
- Include the source of your information (use references).

# Audience awareness

- Never turn your back on the audience.
- Look at the audience as much as you can.
- Turn your body through a 160o angle to face different sections of the audience.
- Never read from your slides or word by word from notes.

# Design of PowerPoint slides

- Choose an appropriate style (neutral colors).
- Avoid special effects and animation.
- Create a balance between text and visuals.
- Use the Spelling Check in PowerPoint.
- Proofread for grammatical errors.
- Use a large text size (32-point used here).
- Use 1 slide maximum for a 1 minute presentation.

# General advice

- Prepare your presentation well in advance.
- Write keywords or prompts on small cards.
- Timing: practice so that you speak for 5-8 minutes.
- Record your presentation. Use the assessment sheet to check you have covered all aspects.
- Remember that presentation and practice are the secrets of a good presentation!

# Ending the presentation

- Quickly summarise the main points.
- State that you would like to finish the presentation.
- Thank the audience for listening.
- Ask the audiences for questions.



# Handling questions

- Anticipate questions and research answers before the presentation.
- If someone asks about a certain section of your presentation, display the slide on the screen.
- If you don't understand the question, ask the person to repeat it or rephrase it yourself ("Do you mean ...").
- If you are unable to answer, say thank you and that you will check the answer.

# Language skills

- Use a formal style of language.
- Speak at a moderate speed.
- Check the pronunciation of any unusual specialist or technical terms.
- Try to vary the intonation in your voice. Try using rhetorical questions to add variety.